

SANTA BARBARA.

A Visitor's Views Regarding its Climate and Attractions.

[From the Indianapolis Sentinel.]

SANTA BARBARA, Feb. 5th, 1882.

Somebody once said that the climates of Heaven and Santa Barbara were similar. This statement may be a little strong, but there is no denying the fact that Santa Barbara has among the finest, if not the finest, climate in the United States. It is between cold, foggy, windy San Francisco and hot, oppressive San Diego, and strikes a happy medium, having all the good qualities of those places and very few of the bad ones. For the past month or six weeks it has been remarkably cold for this place, and on one occasion we awoke one morning to find the mountains covered with snow and the tops of the foot-hills slightly sprinkled with that same beautiful (?) substance. This had never oc-

tiful (?) substance. This had never occurred before within the memory of the oldest inhabitant, as many of the school children (and also some few of the grown up) had never before seen snow, they were wild with delight, and some of the more hardy boys went to the top of the hills and brought a load into town. Then they engaged in one of the chief delights of the Eastern boy, a good old-fashioned snow ball fight. An Indianapolis boy would have smiled to see the rapture with which the Santa Barbara boy patted and fondled the dirty white mixture they called snow. In the East it would have been called "slush." However, the youngsters enjoyed it hugely, and for the last time, unless they emigrate to a colder climate. They will probably never have the same chance again in sunny Santa Barbara.

Flowers are very plenty at this time of the year, but during March, April and May is the time to see them in their glory. Roses bloom here all the year round, and for size and beauty of coloring I defy the world to produce their equal. From a single Gloire de Dijon

ing I deny the world to produce their equal. From a single Gloire de Dijon bush in our front yard my sisters clip enough buds every morning to decorate the entire house. Some of our Eastern people may feel inclined to be a little skeptical, but when I tell them that the bush is about fifteen feet in height and several inches in diameter at the base, maybe they will feel more like believing. An Eastern person who has never seen it has no idea of the profusion with which flowers grow in California, and especially in the Southern part. In the Ojai Valley, a beautiful valley in the mountains, about forty miles south of this place, I believe that wild flowers reach their perfection. In the spring and summer months the valley and hillsides are literally covered with these little volunteers of nature. The poppies are particularly noticeable for their variety of shades and great size.

The situation of Santa Barbara could not be improved upon. It has a magnificent frontage on the Santa Barbara Channel, and is flanked on the northeast by the lofty Santa Ynez Mountains, and on the northwest by a range of foot-

by the lofty Santa Theresa mountains, and on the northwest by a range of foothills, making a triangular-shaped valley for Santa Barbara, "The Beautiful," to nestle in. Across the channel are the rugged Channel Islands, at a distance of from twenty to sixty miles. Scribner's Monthly a few months ago, published an account of an Indian woman who was left, during a storm, upon one of these islands, and roamed for over twenty years over her rocky fastness, and when found had forgotten her native language and become thoroughly wild. In the meantime her tribe had died out, and no one could be found who could understand her broken sentences. She did not live long after she was brought to Santa Barbara, but soon succumbed to civilization. The old Captain who found her still lives in this place, and is always ready to tell the story in his own graphic manner.

The greatest drawback that Santa Barbara has to contend with is the fact that it has no railroad. Several times it has been on the eve of having one

built, but every time something interferes. The Atlantic & Pacific people were just ready to build at one time, but the Central Pacific monopoly gobbled it, and as it was not to their interest to let Santa Barbara have a road, why, they did not let her have one. In time, after the C. P. Railroad is crushed, Santa Barbara will get a railroad, but in my opinion, not before. The C. P. has a way of controlling things in this country, and making things work around for their benefit. The people are getting awful tired of it, and, before a great while, something will probably drop, and great will be the fall thereof.

While I am on the subject I might as well say that California is controlled by monopolies. The China and Australian Steamship Company is a monopoly. The Central Pacific is a gigantic monopoly. The cities are run by monopolies. Trade is carried on by monopolies. The stock market is dictated to by monopolies, and in fact almost every branch of business on this coast is operated by a monopoly. Any body can

erated by a monopoly. Any body can get rich in California if they only can get into a monopoly, but the trouble is you can't get into that desired position. This State is not named right. It should be called Monopolifornia. That name would fit it like a glove.

When I started out I intended to write about Santa Barbara, but when I get started on "monopolies" I don't know when to stop, so please pardon the digression. Santa Barbara is well off in the matter of hotels, three are now running, and all seem to be full. The "Arlington" is the best, and for solid comfort and convenience is not equaled south of San Francisco. The others are good houses. Three steamers per week arrive from San Francisco, and every one comes loaded down with health and pleasure seekers for this point. The fact is rapidly becoming known that this place cannot be beaten on the American continent for enjoyment of life. You know what that means—good health and contentment. Living is not expensive. At the Ar-

means—good health and contentment. Living is not expensive. At the Arlington the price is only \$15 per week, and keeping house is as cheap in proportion. For ten cents you can get a ridiculously large quantity of vegetables. Meat is twelve and a half cents per pound. Washing is done by the Chinese at so much per week, say \$1.25 for a family of five. House rent is rather high, but not nearly so much as in Los Angeles or San Diego. When you come to the luxuries, you have to pay for them, that is, all except horses. For \$30 one can get a very good riding animal, and for \$75 or \$80 a very fair roadster can be obtained. I am the fortunate or unfortunate possessor of a mustang, a real thoroughbred. Before I came to this country I always understood that a mustang was next door to a devil, but such is not the case. The mustang is nearer human than any other breed of horses, and will behave exactly as it is used to being treated. If it has been abused, it looks upon mankind as its natural enemy, and is always on the lookout for a chance to get a little revenge. But on the con-

always on the lookout for a chance to get a little revenge. But, on the contrary, if it has been owned by a white man and kindly treated, no animal can be gentler and safer. My little horse has always been well treated, and a better or kinder horse cannot be found, and, remember, she is a pure bred mustang. As a rule, mustangs are smaller than American horses, but are stronger in proportion to their size. I suppose it is because they have less weight to carry, and are just as muscular. When I first came to this State I would not use a Spanish saddle, but clung to the English wafer style. I soon got out of that notion, and now use a regular "sia" the most pronounced of Spanish saddles. One of these saddles is a rather ungainly object to look at, but it is mighty comfortable riding. Hereafter, for ease and comfort, commend me to a Spanish saddle.

Mrs. Helen Hunt Jackson, of the Century Magazine, is now here, writing up the California missions. Santa Barbara glories in a grand old mission, built over 100 years ago by the Franciscan monks. It is situated back of the town on the foot-hills and is the

ciscan mission. It is situated on the top of the town on the foot-hills, and is the first object which strikes the eye on landing from the steamer. It is a large building and can be seen for miles. The building is constructed of adobe, and is roofed with tiling. There was not a nail used in building, the rafters being tied with thongs of rawhide, which are as strong now as the day they were first put up. There are several heartrending statues and paintings in the chapel, one being a life-size representation of Christ on the cross. It is a most lifelike thing, and is calculated to give nervous people the nightmare for a week. The expression of agony on the face and the contortions of the limbs are most horrible. They used to have a statue of some saint that would cry, real tears running down the cheeks. This was a great marvel to the ignorant people until it was discovered that there was a cup of water inside the head, that worked by a string. Since then the statue has disappeared. The graveyard attached to the Mission reminds one of the graveyards seen in Europe. It is enclosed by a high wall and is so

one of the graveyards seen in Europe. It is enclosed by a high wall, and is so full of bodies that bones stick out all over the ground. It is not used any more.

Santa Barbara has one daily and two weekly newspapers. The evening *Press* has a circulation of about 1,000 copies. It is a good, live paper. Mr. C. F. McGlashan, the genial editor and proprietor, is just the man for the place, and does Santa Barbara a power of good. This paper has also a weekly number. The weekly *Independent* is a good paper. Santa Barbara's population is 5,000, and is growing. Good stores, fine churches and handsome residences are numerous. We have a daily mail from San Francisco, Los Angeles and the East. I am very much afraid that I will have to go home in the spring; I don't want to, but reasons over which I have no control compel. I have been in California just long enough (two years) to be infatuated with its climate, and if it were not for my father I believe I would like to live here; but the fiat has gone forth, and I must obey.

The sun is just setting, and the tints on the mountains are lovely. Nowhere,

with the exception of Italy, do they have finer sunsets than here. A gentleman, who has traveled all over the world, told me that, and I take his word for it. They are good enough for me, any how.

I saw Henry Talbot in San Francisco just before he sailed for Japan. He was looking as jolly as ever.

Indian people are not very plentiful in this part of the country, but when I find one I freeze to him.

Here, I have strung this out into quite a letter, but I did not mean to when I started.

I will wind up by saying that Santa Barbara is the sanitarium of the United States, and any body who is afflicted with any one of the ailments that flesh is heir to had better come here and get cured.

SÉNOR BLANCO.